Neighborhood Pods — Logic Spec

Oct 9, 2026 · @Daejon

Overview

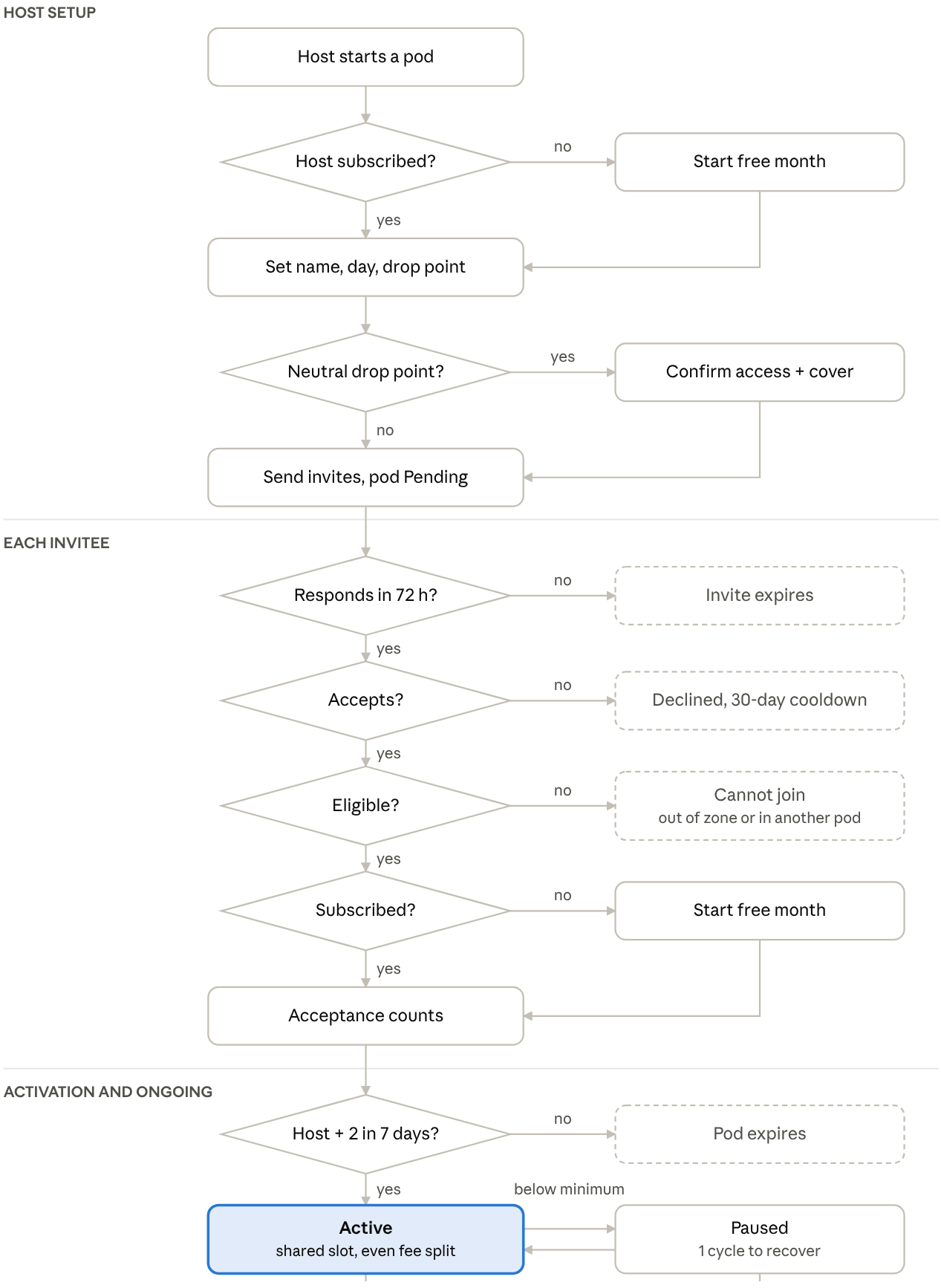
A Neighborhood Pod is a group of nearby subscribed households that share one drop point and one delivery day, and split the delivery fee evenly. A host starts the pod and invites neighbors; the pod only goes live once enough invitees approve.

- **Who can use it:** subscribers only — every member, host included.
- **What it shares:** a drop point, a delivery day, an order cutoff, and the delivery fee.
- **What it does not share:** orders, payments, or members' home addresses. Each member checks out individually and HarvestHub remains merchant of record per order.

Logic flow

The full path from a host starting a pod to an active, paused, or dissolved pod, with every decision point.

Invitees must opt in before a pod goes live





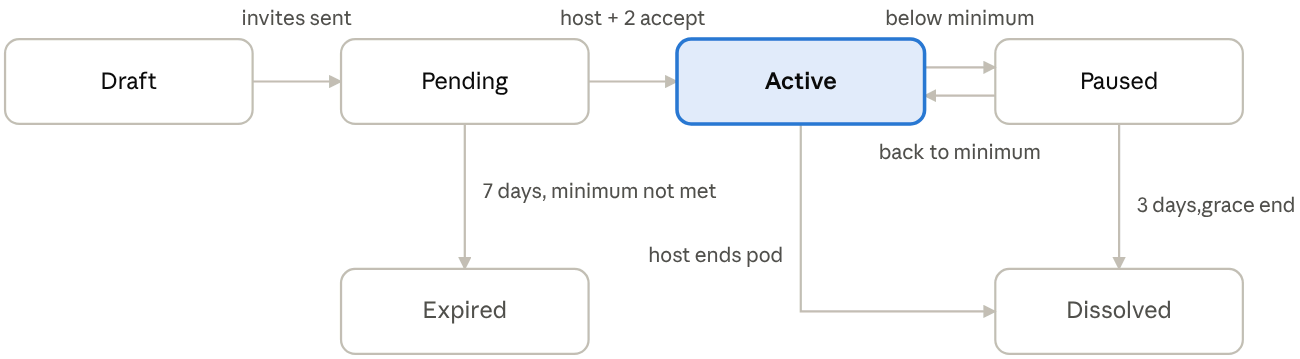
end-to-end pod logic · 3 phases, 7 decisions

Dashed boxes are end states. The invitee phase runs once per invitee, in parallel; the activation check counts all acceptances together.

Pod lifecycle

A pod moves through six states and can take orders only while Active.

A pod takes orders only while Active



pod lifecycle · 6 states

- **Draft:** host sets pod name, drop point, and delivery day. Visible to no one.
- **Pending:** invites are out; the pod cannot take orders.
- **Active:** minimum reached; shared slot and fee split unlock.
- **Paused:** dropped below minimum; one delivery cycle of grace to recover.
- **Expired:** minimum not met within 7 days of the first invite.
- **Dissolved:** host ended the pod, or the grace period ran out.

Activation rule

A pod activates when the host plus at least 2 invitees have accepted and each of them holds an active subscription.

- Acceptance counts only once the invitee's subscription is active (a free-month subscription counts).
- Activation does not wait on every invitee. Waiting on all invitees would let one unresponsive neighbor stall the pod.
- Invitees who accept after activation join immediately, up to the size cap.
- If the minimum is not reached within 7 days of the first invite, the pod expires and all open invites are cancelled.

Invites

The host invites by SMS or email; each invite resolves to one of five states.

Invite state	How it is reached
Sent	Host sends the invite
Accepted	Invitee approves and passes eligibility checks
Declined	Invitee says no
Expired	No response within 72 hours
Revoked	Host withdraws it before a response

Eligibility is checked at acceptance, not at invite time:

- Address is inside the HarvestHub delivery zone.
- Address is within the radius of the pod's drop point (default 0.5 mi).
- Not already in another pod on the same delivery day.
- Active subscription, or starts one during acceptance.

Limits:

- Size cap of 8 households, host included.
- A declined invitee cannot be re-invited by the same host for 30 days.
- Non-users follow the invite link through sign-up, then return to the accept screen.

Accept flow and privacy

The accept screen states exactly what joining shares, so approval is informed consent.

1. Invitee opens the link and sees the host's first name, pod name, drop point, and delivery day.
2. Screen lists what is shared: their first name with other members, and that they collect at the drop point.
3. Screen lists what is never shared: their home address, order contents, and payment details.
4. Screen shows the fee terms: the delivery fee is split evenly among members.
5. Non-subscribers start their free month here; subscribers skip this step.
6. Eligibility checks run; on pass, the invite moves to Accepted.

Subscription requirement

Every member, host included, must hold an active subscription for the whole time they are in a pod.

- **Creating a pod:** requires an active subscription; free-month subscribers qualify.
- **Joining:** non-subscribers start their free month as part of accepting, which makes pods a built-in acquisition loop.
- **Free month ending:** send a reminder a few days before conversion. If the member does not convert, they leave the pod at the end of the current cycle.
- **Member lapse or cancel:** removed at the end of the current cycle. Messaging stays factual ("your pod will have N members").
- **Host lapse or cancel:** treated as the host leaving (see Membership changes).
- **Benefit framing:** show pod savings as a subscriber benefit, e.g. "your pod saves you $X per delivery".

Drop point

The host chooses either their home or a neutral location when creating the pod.

Rule	Home	Neutral (lobby, porch, community space)
Host attests permission to use it	Implied	Required
Access notes for driver (gate, door code)	Optional	Required if applicable

Rule	Home	Neutral (lobby, porch, community space)
Covered or shaded spot noted	Recommended	Required

- The eligibility radius is measured from the drop point, not the host's home.
- Cold items are flagged for pickup within a set window after delivery.
- Changing the drop point on an active pod requires members to re-approve, since it changes what they agreed to. Members who don't re-approve leave at the end of the cycle.

Orders and fee split

The delivery fee is split evenly across all active members each delivery cycle; everything else stays individual.

- Each member checks out on their own; HarvestHub is merchant of record per order.
- All members share one order cutoff tied to the pod's delivery day.
- Fee share = pod delivery fee ÷ number of active members that cycle.
- The accept screen states the split terms up front.

Membership changes

Any departure takes effect after open orders are fulfilled, so no delivery is disrupted mid-cycle.

- **Member leaves:** removed after their open order. If the pod drops below the minimum, it moves to Paused.
- **Host leaves:** must hand hosting to an existing member or dissolve the pod. Members are notified before the next cutoff.
- **New host and drop point:** if the drop point was the old host's home, the new host sets a new drop point and members re-approve.
- **Paused pod:** members have one delivery cycle of grace to bring in a new member; otherwise the pod dissolves.
- **Host revokes a member:** effective after that member's open order, with notice to them.

Defaults to tune

These values are starting placeholders, not decisions.

Setting	Default
Minimum to activate	Host + 2 accepted members
Size cap	8 households
Invite expiry	72 hours
Pod expiry if minimum not met	7 days
Eligibility radius from drop point	0.5 mi
Re-invite cooldown after decline	30 days
Grace period when below minimum	1 delivery cycle